CFS INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Quick Reference: Microsoft Authenticator

Text message and phone call sign in codes end February 1, 2027. Set up Authenticator now.

What changes on February 1, 2027: Microsoft stops sending text message and phone call codes for work accounts. If that is your only way to verify, you will be stopped at sign in and required to set up a passkey before you can reach email, Teams, Paycom or anything else that uses your CFS login. Setting up Authenticator now avoids that. Password resets by text message end the same day.

SET UP AUTHENTICATOR (ABOUT 5 MINUTES)

You need your phone and a computer.

1. **Check where you stand.** On a computer, go to **aka.ms/mysecurityinfo** and sign in with your CFS email. If **Microsoft Authenticator** is already listed, skip to step 5.
2. **Install the app.** On your phone, open the App Store or Google Play, search for **Microsoft Authenticator**, and install the free app from Microsoft Corporation. Open it and allow notifications.
3. **Start on the computer.** On the Security info page, click **Add sign in method**, choose **Microsoft Authenticator**, and click **Next** until a QR code appears.
4. **Scan the code.** In the app, tap **+**, choose **Work or school account**, then **Scan QR code**. Click **Next** on the computer. Type the number shown on your computer into your phone and tap **Yes**.
5. **Make it your default.** Next to **Default sign in method**, click **Change** and choose the Microsoft Authenticator notification. If Microsoft offers to set up a passkey, say yes. It lives in the same app.

EVERY TIME YOU SIGN IN

Your computer shows a number. Your phone asks, "Are you trying to sign in?" Type that number and tap **Yes**.

Do approve only a sign in you just started yourself.

Never approve one you did not start. Tap **No, it's not me** and tell the Help Desk.

GOOD TO KNOW

Personal phone? That is fine. The app does not give CFS access to your photos, texts, contacts or anything else on your phone.

Getting a new phone? While the old phone still works, repeat steps 2 to 5 on the new one. If the old phone is already gone, contact the Help Desk.

A "set up a passkey" screen right after you sign in on a Microsoft page is legitimate. Follow it.

NO SMARTPHONE, OR STUCK?

Email **HelpDesk@cfsny.org** with your name, your program and how you sign in today, and we will work out the right option with you. The same goes for a new or broken phone. Please do not wait until January.